Army Corps of Engineers (Civil Works)

One-page brief

Priority: 14 of 33 (score 3.2). **FY2026 outlays:** $28B (USAspending). **As of:** 2026-10-27. Public data only.

Bottom line

The Corps spends almost entirely through construction and dredging contracts, many of them small business set-asides, and it ramps up sharply after disasters. That makes it a near copy of the DoD contractor screen at a smaller scale. Bid rigging among a few regional dredging and construction firms is the second pattern.

Exposure

- $28B in outlays and $77B in budgetary resources in FY2026, boosted by infrastructure and disaster supplemental money.
- Set-aside fronts, bid rigging and inflated change orders are recurring case types for the Army CID and DOJ's Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

Public data we can use

- **FPDS / USAspending:** awards, set-aside type, number of offers, modifications.
- **SAM.gov** entities and exclusions; SBA certification lists.
- **DOJ and Army CID** case releases.

Detection plays

1. **Front companies:** the DoD set-aside screen (see dod.pdf) applied to Corps districts.
2. **Collusion signals:** few bidders per award, stable win rotation, and shared officers among "competitors" in a district.
3. **Change-order growth:** contracts whose value grows far beyond award compared with peer projects.

First prototype

Run the DoD contractor integrity screen on Corps awards and add a district-level bid rotation view.

Geodesic Solutions: geodesic.pro *Contact: Steve Taylor, Managing Partner: taylor@geodesic.pro*

Limits

Bid amounts for losing offers are not in FPDS; collusion tests rely on number of offers and win patterns.

Who to take it to

USACE Directorate of Contracting, Army CID Major Procurement Fraud Unit, DoD OIG, and DOJ's Procurement Collusion Strike Force.

Sources

- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)
- DOJ Procurement Collusion Strike Force

